

Distress Tolerance — ACCEPTS & Self-Soothe

Greater Nashua Mental Health Center

Instructions: Distress tolerance skills help you get through a crisis without making it worse, when you can't fix the situation right now. ACCEPTS distracts; self-soothing uses the five senses. Plan yours in advance.

ACCEPTS — Distract wisely

A — Activities (engaging things to do)

C — Contributing (help someone, do something kind)

C — Comparisons (to a time you coped, or to those coping with less)

E — Emotions (opposite emotion: funny video, uplifting music)

P — Pushing away (set the problem aside briefly; imagine a box on a shelf)

T — Thoughts (count, puzzles, recite something)

S — Sensations (hold ice, hot shower, strong taste)

Self-soothe with the five senses

Vision	Hearing	Smell	Taste	Touch

My crisis-survival kit — items/activities to keep ready: